PIXELS IN FOCUS



THE HYUNDAI IONIQ 5 MAKES A LOT OF SENSE—THE SIZE, THE TECH AND THE COMFORT ALL ENOUGH TO TRUMP ICE-POWERED CARS. WE FIND OUT HOW GOOD THE INDIA-SPEC CAR REALLY IS

BY ANAGH BHASKAR

While we see new electric cars almost every month now, there are some which deserve special attention. One of these is the Hyundai Ioniq 5 because of the immense effort put into its development—from the design and aesthetics to the powertrain. Hyundai has used the E-GMP (Electric Global Modular Platform), which underpins the Kia EV6 that was launched in India last year. Both cars, however, couldn't look any different, with the Kia following a sportier approach, while the Ioniq 5 is neo-retro. The design looks akin to something we saw in sci-fi flicks from the 1980s, inspired by the iconic Hyundai Pony. The shape is of an oversized hatchback, but do not let its form factor fool you into thinking it's a small car. In fact, this electric SUV is large with a wheelbase of 3,000mm, comparable with the likes of the Range Rover Sport and the Audi Q7. Being electric, the Ioniq 5 sports a frunk, with 57 litres of storage in addition to a 527-litre boot under the electrically operated tailgate.



There are other benefits of the elongated wheelbase, like cabin space. There is a very airy feel about the cabin, the colours are a very smart choice and blend with the contrast of the lighter colours of the seats, making for a great cabin feel. There are two 12.3-inch displays, one for instrumentation and one for infotainment. The HVAC—generally placed behind the dashboard—has been shifted to the engine bay, hence freeing up the space below the dashboard. If you park your car in a very tight spot and do not have the space to open the driver's door, you can simply cross over to the passenger seat and get out. The seats are draped in eco-processed fabric, and come with electric adjustability, ventilation and heating; even the headrest is electrically adjustable. Seating in the back too is splendid with a lot of kneeroom and legroom, especially given the fact that the rear seats too are adjustable. However, only the fore and aft movement is electrically adjustable while the seatback recline has to be adjusted manually. Storage